Chapter 3:
TWO STORIES ABOUT FLYING

I. His First Flight
(Conquering Fear)

II. The Black Aeroplane
(Navigating the Unknown)

Master Revision Comic — Class 10 English

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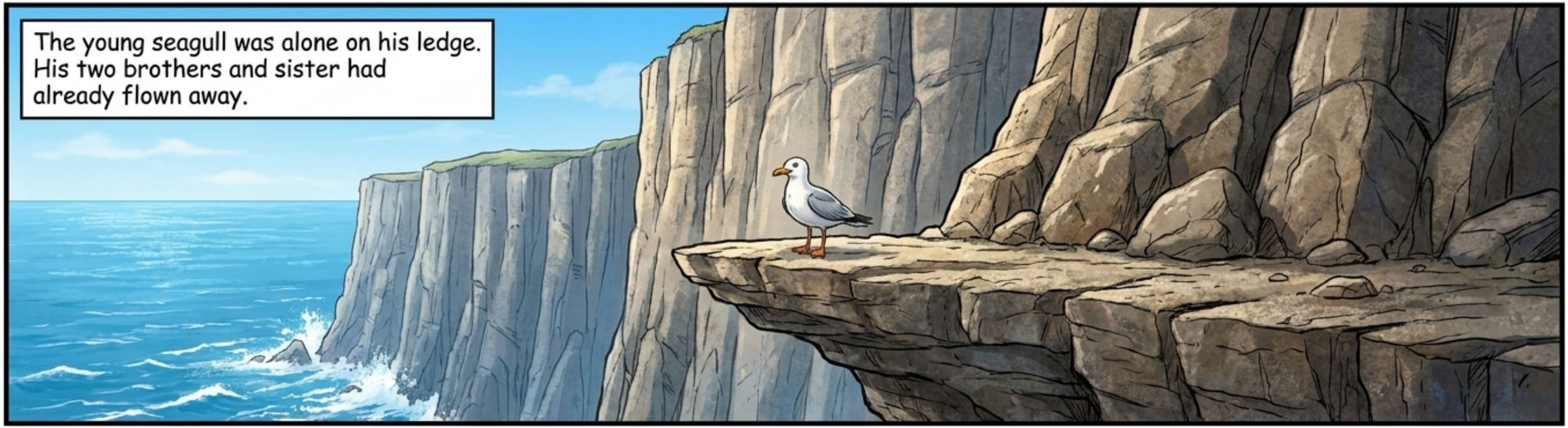

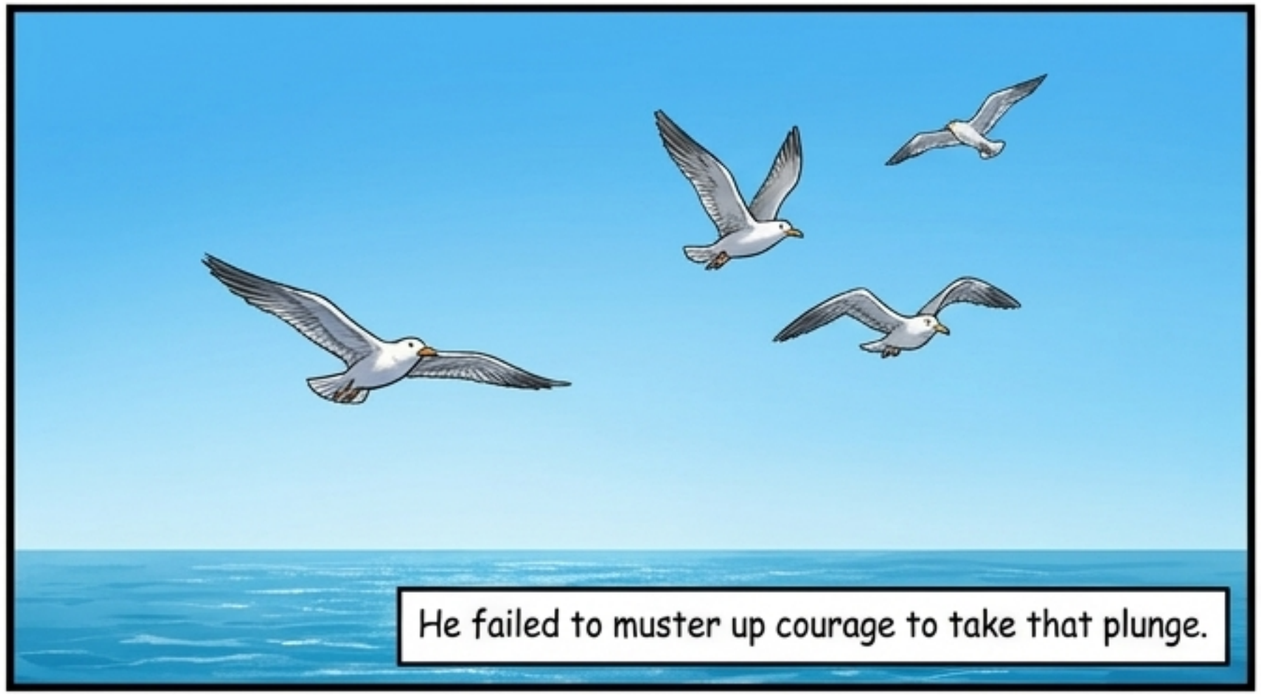

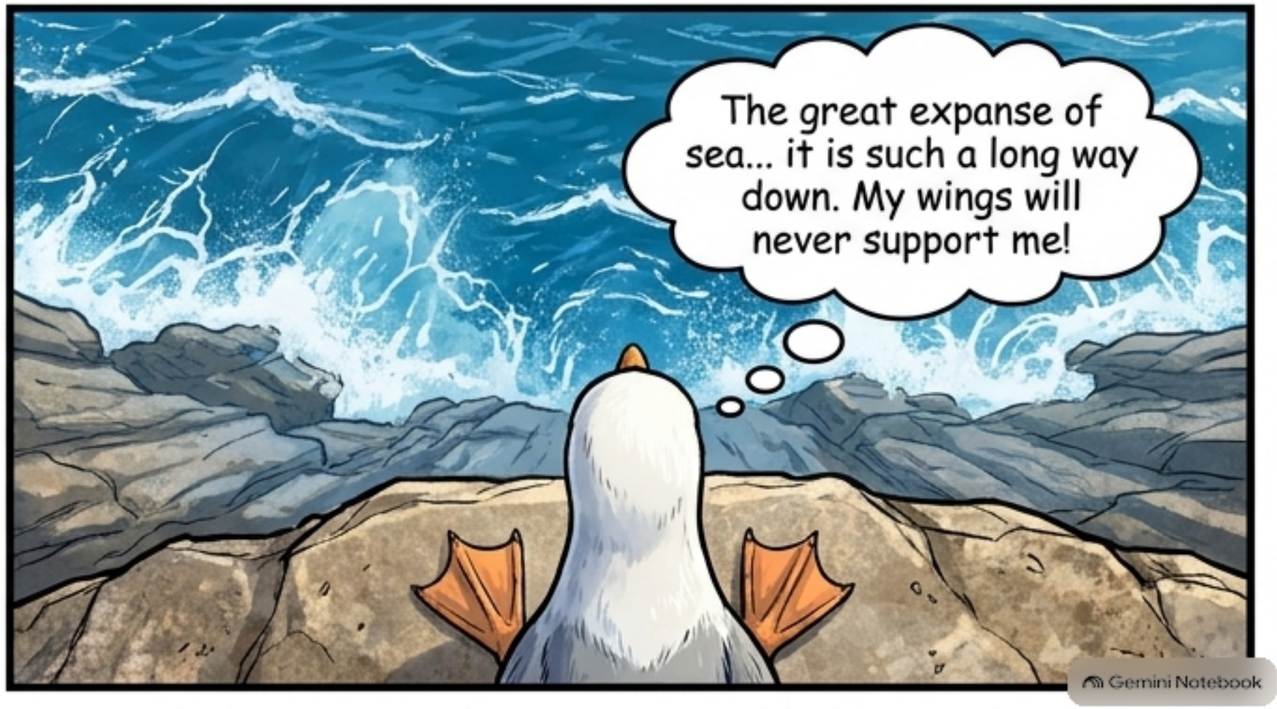

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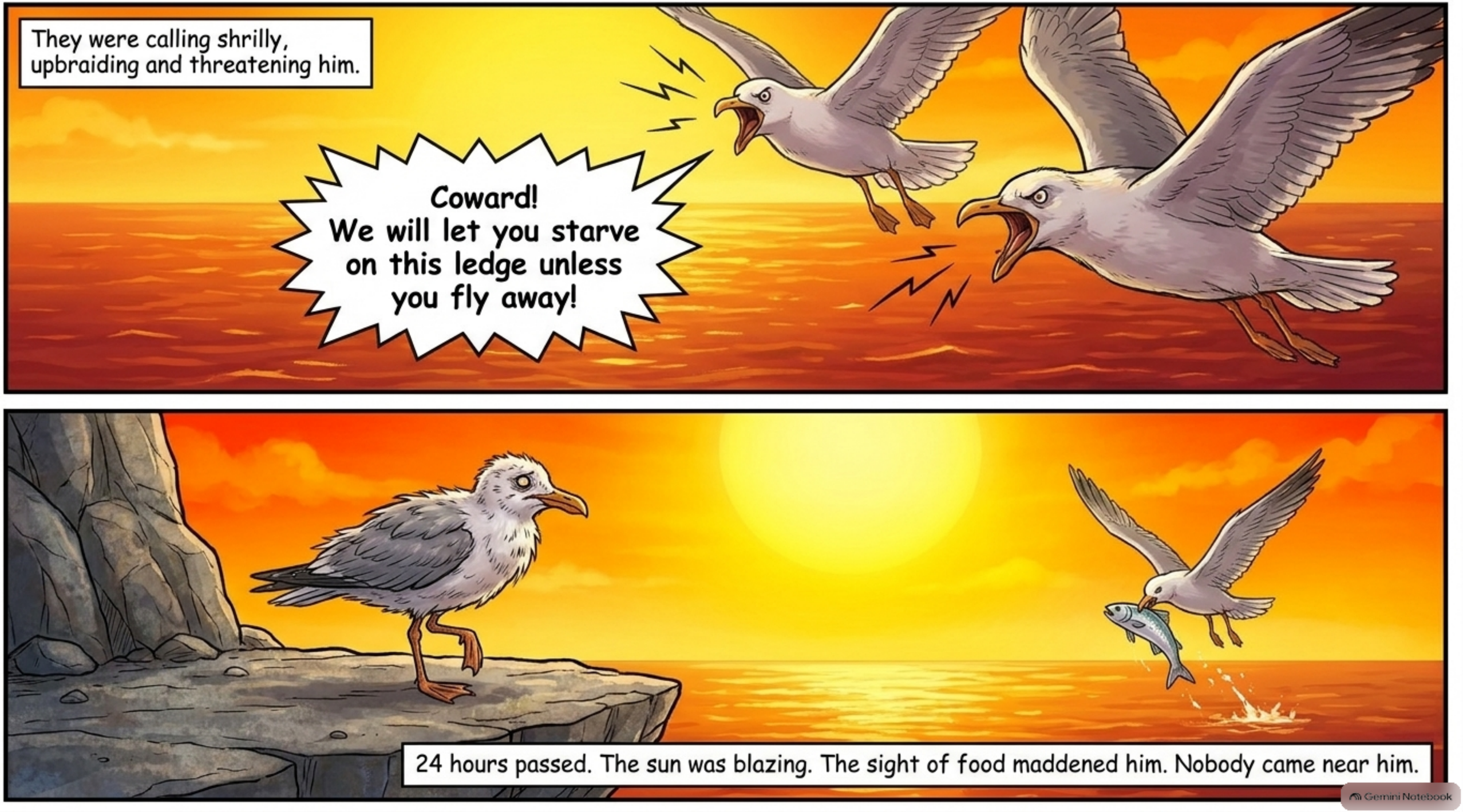
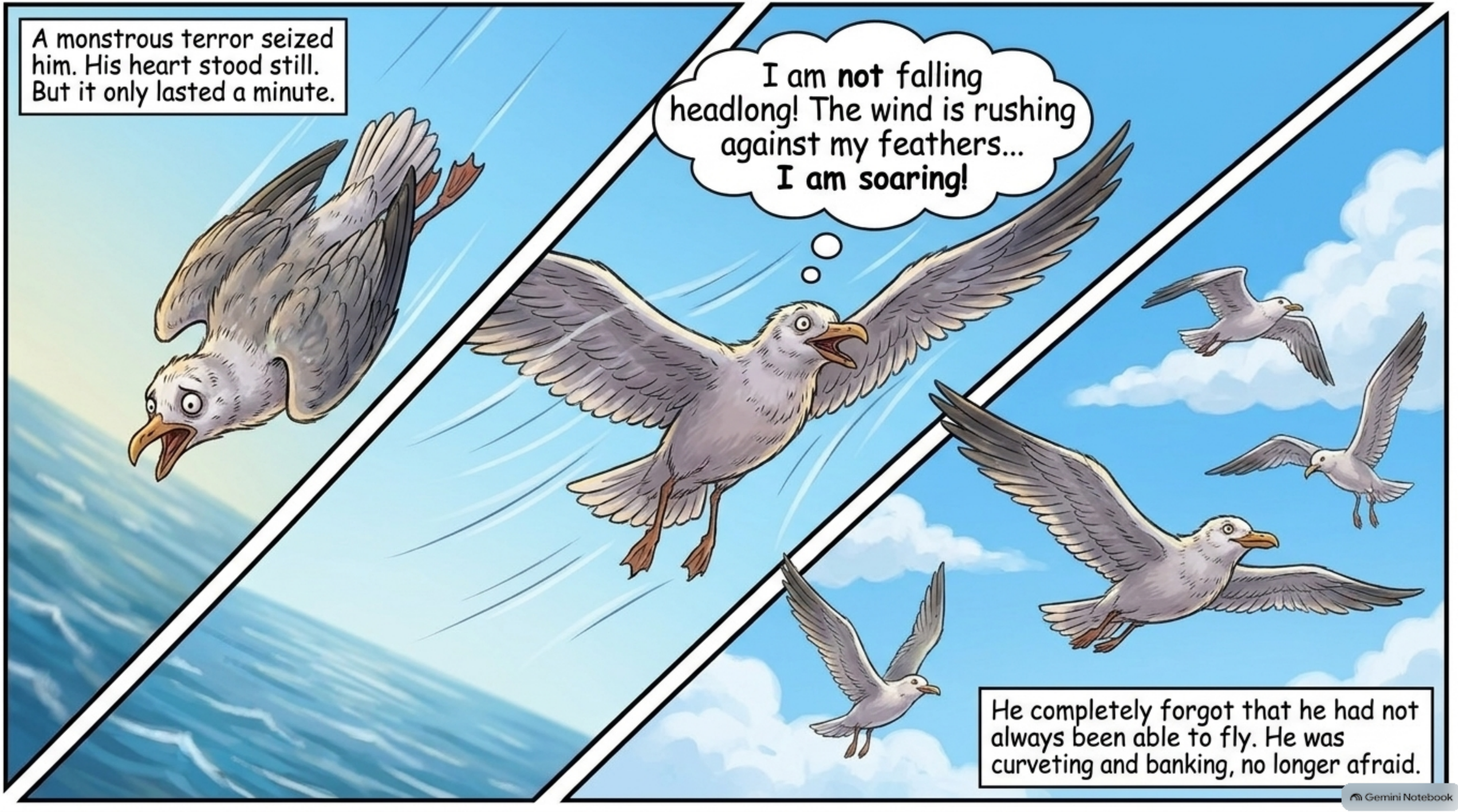
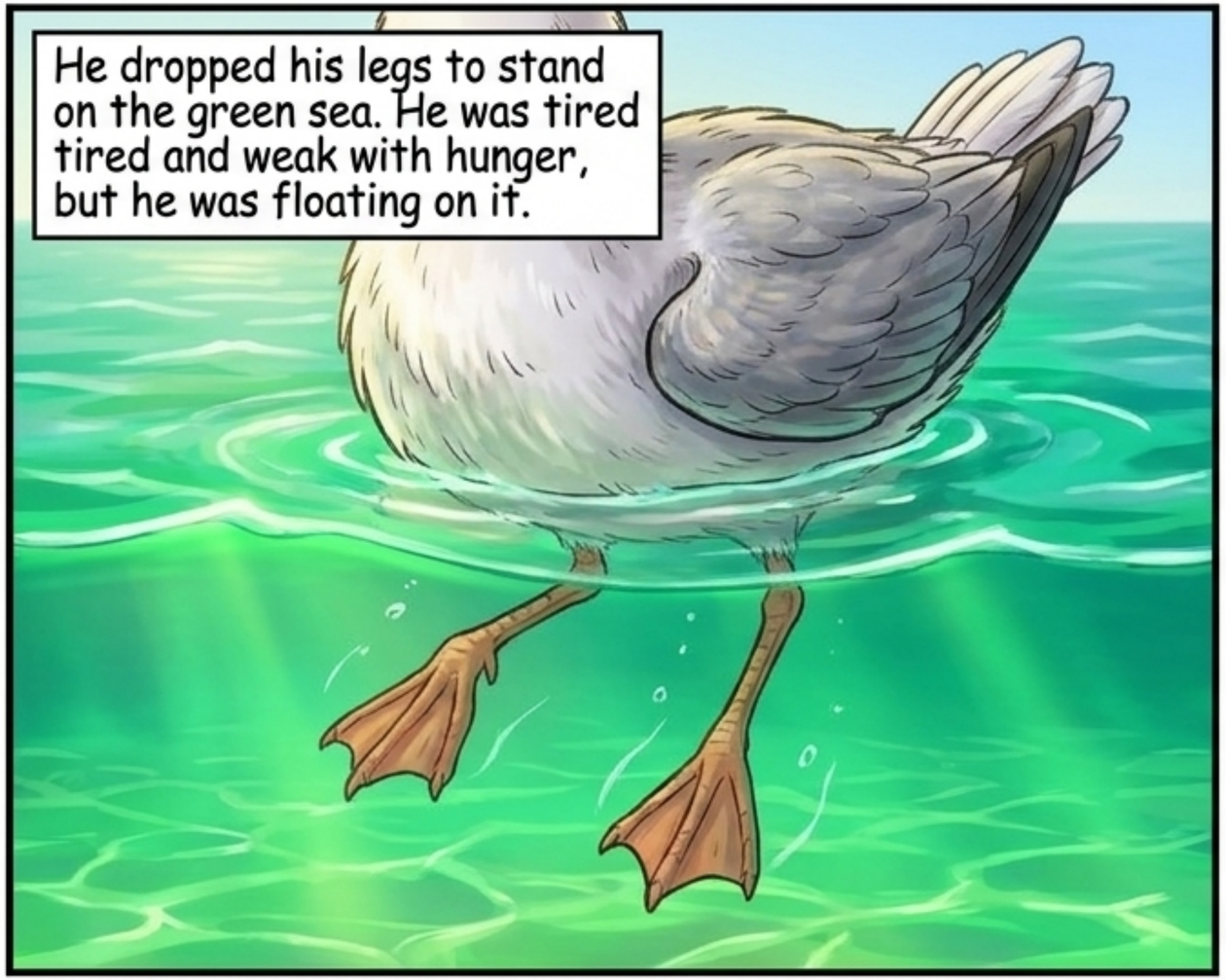
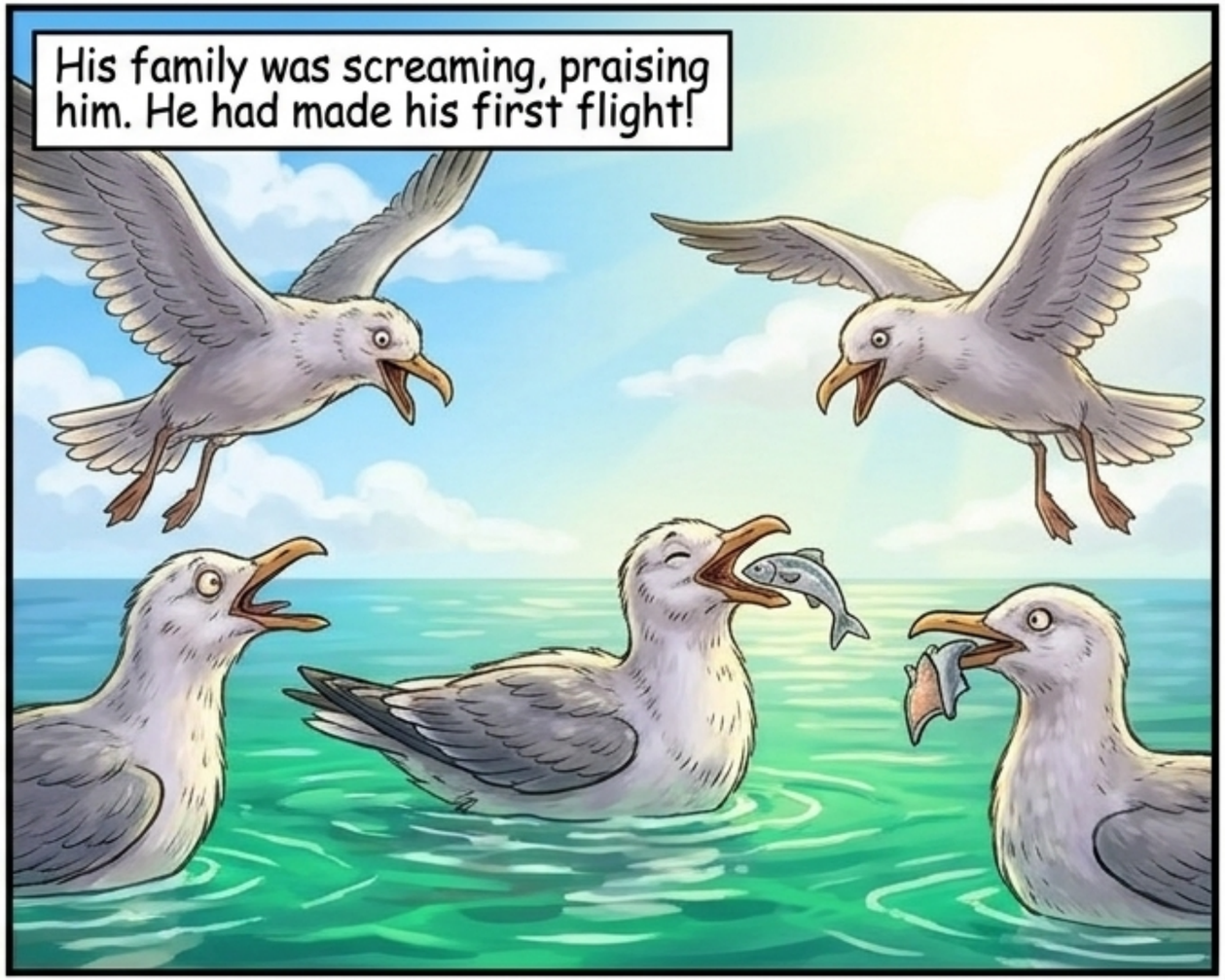

They were calling shrilly, upbraiding and threatening him.
Coward! We will let you starve on this ledge unless you fly away!
24 hours passed. The sun was blazing. The sight of food maddened him. Nobody came near him.

She halted, her wings motionless, the piece of fish almost within reach.
Ga, ga, ga!
Gaw-col-ah!
Maddened by hunger, he dived at the fish! With a loud scream, he fell outwards and downwards into space...


A monstrous terror seized him. His heart stood still. But it only lasted a minute.
I am **not** falling headlong! The wind is rushing against my feathers... **I am soaring!**
He completely forgot that he had not always been able to fly. He was curveting and banking, no longer afraid.





LESSON: Fear is only in the mind. Courage comes when you are forced to take a leap. Necessity drives action.

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SUPER REVISION COMIC 1: His First Flight

1. THE FEAR

Young seagull alone on on the ledge, terrified of the vast sea. Wings feel too weak.

2. THE STARVATION

Family leaves him alone for 24 hours. Parents upbraid (scold) him for his cowardice.

3. THE TRICK

Mother brings a piece of fish but halts just out of reach. Maddened by hunger, he dives.

4. THE FLIGHT

Terror turns to joy. Wings spread naturally. He lands safely on the green sea.

Core Exam Theme: Self-confidence / Necessity is the mother of action.

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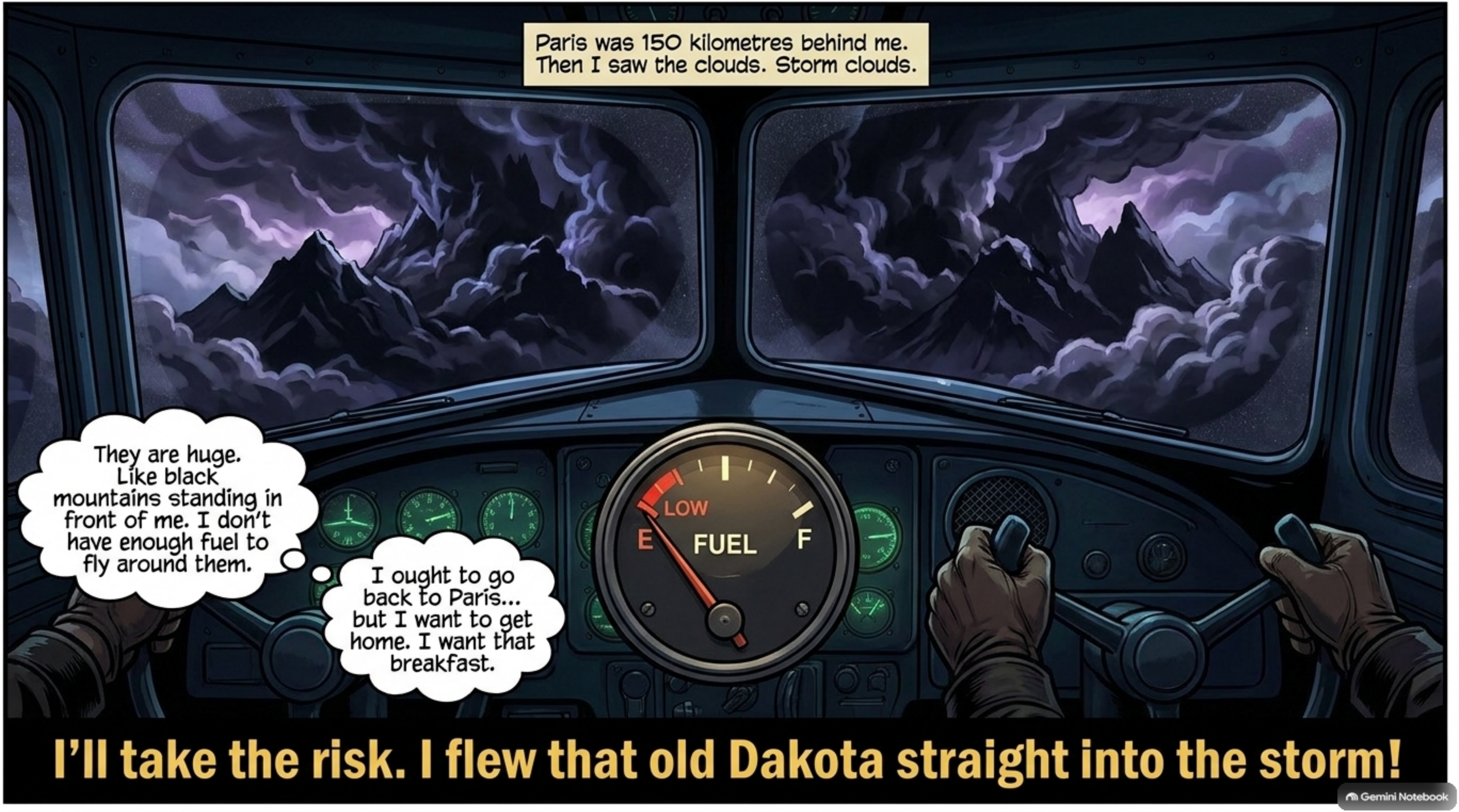
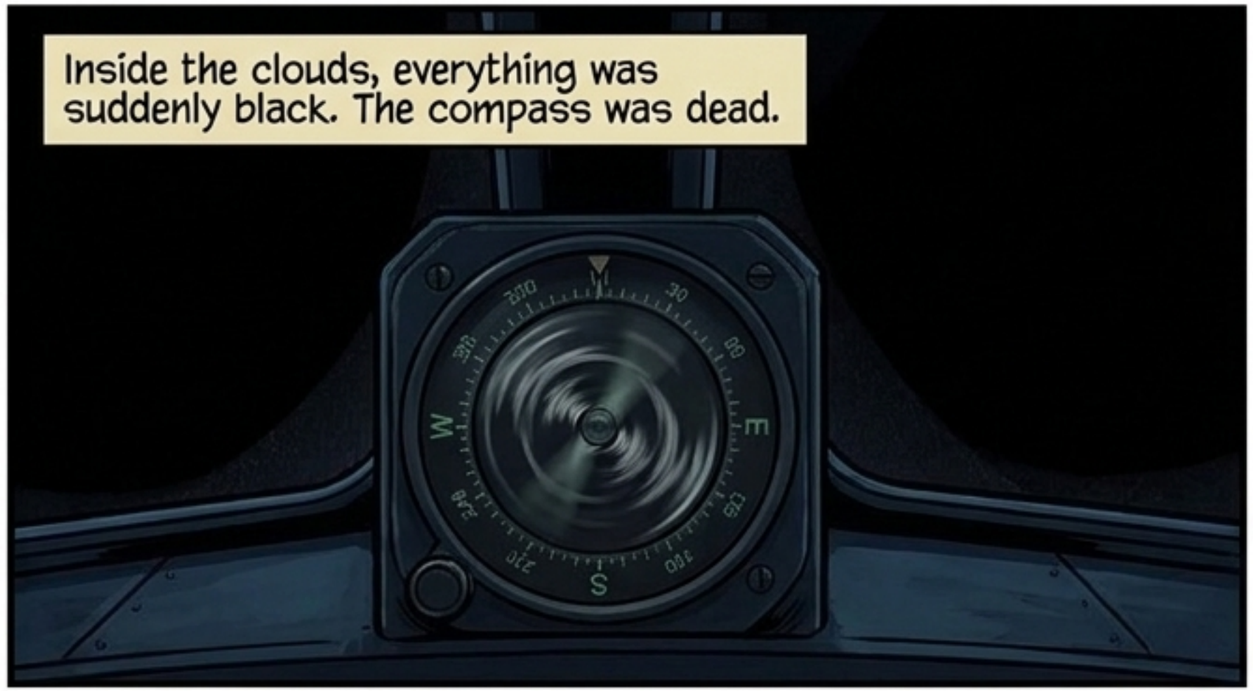
The moon was coming up. I was flying my old Dakota aeroplane over France, back to England.
An easy flight. I'll be in time for a good big English breakfast!
Paris Control, Dakota DS 088 here. I'm on my way to England. Over.
Turn twelve degrees west now, DS 088.


Paris was 150 kilometres behind me. Then I saw the clouds. Storm clouds.
They are huge. Like black mountains standing in front of me. I don't have enough fuel to fly around them.
I ought to go back to Paris... but I want to get home. I want that breakfast.
LOW
E
FUEL
F
I'll take the risk. I flew that old Dakota straight into the storm!



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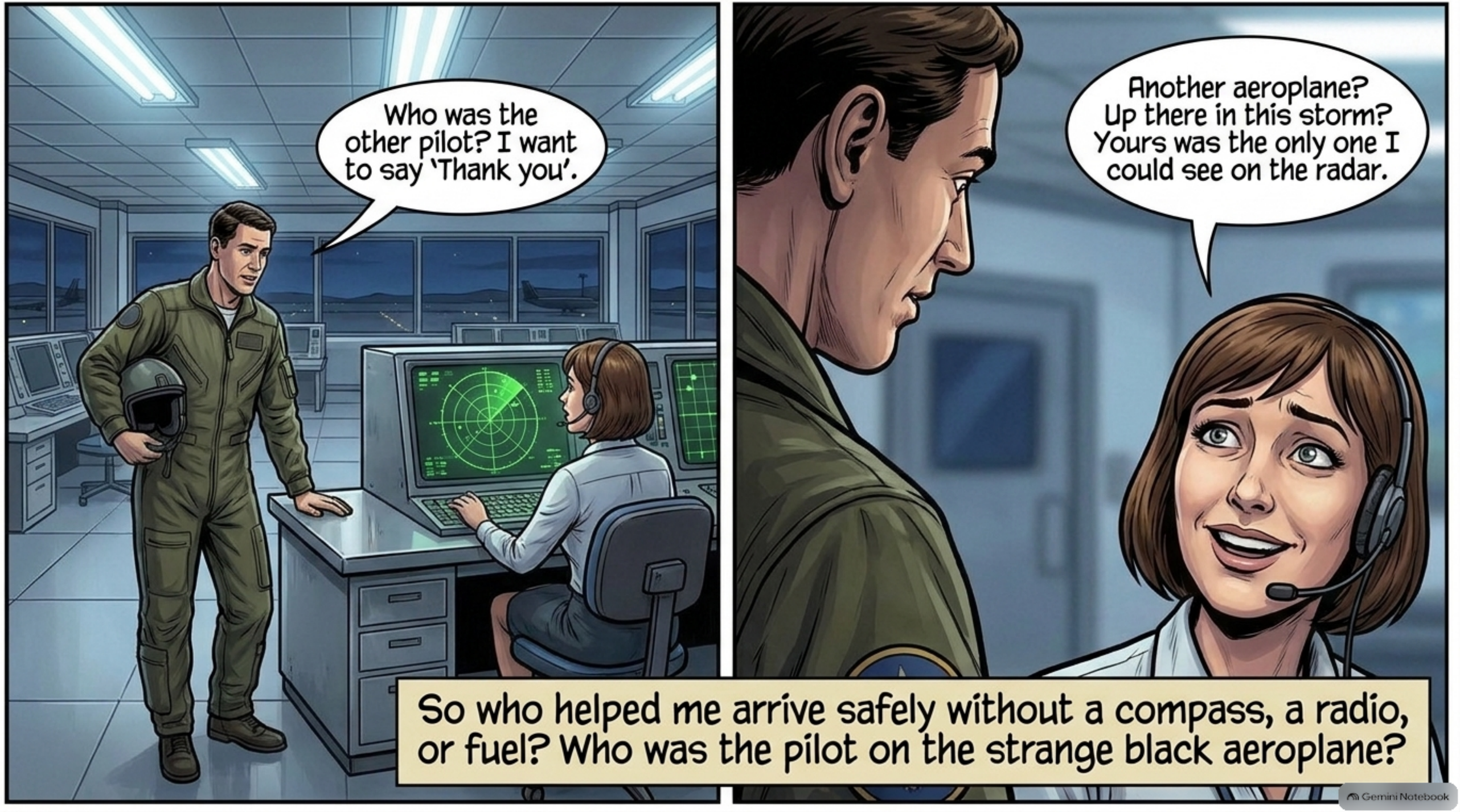
Who was the other pilot? I want to say 'Thank you'.
Another aeroplane? Up there in this storm? Yours was the only one I could see on the radar.
So who helped me arrive safely without a compass, a radio, or fuel? Who was the pilot on the strange black aeroplane?

SUPER REVISION COMIC 2: The Black Aeroplane

1. THE JOURNEY

Pilot flying Dakota DS 088 to England. Clear sky, dreaming of an English breakfast.

2. THE RISK

Encounters huge storm clouds like ‘black mountains’. Decides to take the risk and fly straight into them.

3. THE MYSTERY

Lost. Compass and radio are dead. A mysterious plane with no lights appears and guides him.

4. THE ESCAPE & TWIST

Lands safely on a runway. The control room woman reveals there was NO other plane on the radar.

Core Exam Theme: Miracle vs. Hallucination / The triumph of the human will to survive in panic.

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Board-Oriented Vocabulary

From “His First Flight”

Ledge: A narrow shelf sticking out from a cliff. (Context: Where the seagull was stuck).

Upbraiding: Scolding severely. (Context: Parents scolding his cowardice).

Skim: To move lightly just above the surface. (Context: Parents teaching siblings to skim waves).

Derisively: In a mocking or insulting manner. (Context: Mother mocking his cries).

Curveting / Banking: Flying movements; leaping or flying with one wing higher.

From “The Black Aeroplane”

Compass: An instrument showing direction. (Context: Spun wildly and died in the storm).

Obedient child: Someone who follows instructions without question. (Context: How the pilot followed the black plane).

Radar: A system that detects aircraft in the sky. (Context: Showed only one plane flying that night).

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EXAM BOOSTER: Core Questions

Character & Event Based

Q: "The sight of the food maddened him." What compelled the young seagull to finally fly?

Ans: Extreme hunger made him dive for the fish in his mother's beak, forcing him to instinctively use his wings to survive the fall.

Q: "I'll take the risk." What is the risk and why did the narrator take it?

Ans: The risk was flying an old plane straight into dark, massive storm clouds. He took it because he desperately wanted to get home for an English breakfast.

Inference & Value Based

Q: Who do you think helped the narrator in "The Black Aeroplane" to reach safely?

Ans: It is an **open mystery.** However, **since the radar showed no other plane, it was likely his own subconscious mind (a hallucination) helping him stay calm and survive the panic.**

Q: How do the young seagull's parents teach him the art of flying?

Ans: By **leaving him alone, starving him, taunting his cowardice**, and finally **tricking him with food—teaching him that he must take action to survive.**

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